

Day 4 — Technical Logic Validation & Finalization

Activity packet for participant triads. Today's job: catch every inconsistency across the artifact set, add the **SEP-light** and **DP-light**, integrate everything, and rehearse the presentation. Tomorrow you present.

Where we are in the week

The 4 documents from Day 3 (PRD-light, TCD-light, TMD-light, AI Spec v1) need to be **internally consistent** before they ship. Today's discipline is **technical logic validation** — checking that the data model supports the API, the SLOs match the architecture, the metrics align with the outcome map, and the trade-offs don't contradict.

Plus today produces the last 2 documents: **SEP-light** and **DP-light**, in compressed form.

Inputs

- All 4 documents from Day 3
- Day-3 cross-triad findings
- The SEP / DP templates from Weeks 6–7

What "technical logic validation" means

A common rookie failure: each artifact is fine in isolation, but together they don't fit.

Examples:

- The PRD's NFR says "p95 < 500ms" but the TMD's sequence diagram totals 800ms
- The TCD says "modular monolith" but the TMD shows components that need to deploy independently
- The data model has no foreign key for a relationship the API requires
- The outcome map's "leading indicator" isn't measurable with the observability NFR

Technical logic validation = **walk every cross-artifact reference** and verify they're consistent.

The 7-point validation checklist

#	Check	Where to look
1	Outcome map → metrics → SLOs aligned	DP-light Section 1, PRD-light Section 7, TCD-light Section 4
2	Data model supports the API contract	TMD-light Section 1 ↔ Section 3
3	API contract supports the AC	TMD-light Section 3 ↔ PRD-light Section 6
4	SLO budget fits the sequence diagram	TCD-light Section 4 ↔ TMD-light Section 4
5	NFRs don't contradict the architecture stance	PRD-light Section 7 ↔ TCD-light Section 1
6	Trade-offs don't contradict each other	TCD-light Section 5
7	Stakeholder sign-off captures all constraints	TCD-light Section 6

A triad that passes all 7 has a coherent artifact set. Most fail 2–3 on first pass — that's expected; that's why this day exists.

Activity 1 — The 7-Point Validation

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 1

Purpose

Walk every check; document what passes and what doesn't.

Triad protocol

For each of the 7 checks, the triad walks the cross-references:

1. **Pull both sides of the check** (e.g., for #4: latency SLO target + sequence diagram totals)
2. **Compare** — do they agree?
3. **If yes:** mark pass.
4. **If no:** document the gap. Decide:
 - Tighten the artifact in question (often the answer)
 - Adjust the SLO / NFR (only if evidence demands)
 - Mark as a known gap to call out in the presentation

The validation log:

#	Check	Status	Gap / fix
1	Outcome → metrics → SLOs	Pass	None
2	Data model ↔ API	Partial	Missing FK on User → Order; added
3	API ↔ AC	Pass	None
4	SLO budget ↔ sequence	Fail → Fixed	Sequence totaled 800ms; SLO was 500ms; tightened SLO to p95 < 1000ms with defense
5	NFRs ↔ architecture	Pass	None
6	Trade-offs internal consistency	Pass	None
7	Stakeholders ↔ constraints	Partial	Compliance not on sign-off list; added

Output

A validation log + updated artifacts.

Activity 2 — SEP-Light + DP-Light

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 2

Purpose

Compressed Weeks 6 + 7 in 40 minutes. SEP-light captures stakeholder + 1 trade-off brief + 1 simulated negotiation; DP-light captures outcome map + backlog skeleton + 1 experiment.

SEP-light template

SEP-light – <feature>

1. Stakeholder map (compressed)

3 high-power stakeholders. Power × Interest placement + RACI for 1 decision (the most consequential).

2. 1 Trade-off brief

1 page. Pick one TCD-light Section 5 trade-off; brief for the relevant stakeholder.

3. 1 Simulated negotiation outcome

For one of the 5-most-consequential asks, document:

- The ask
- Anticipated stakeholder response (top 1 objection + your response)
- Anticipated agreement / deferral / escalation path

DP-light template

DP-light – <feature>

1. Outcome map (compressed)

Primary outcome + 2 supporting outcomes + 1 counter-outcome.

2. Backlog skeleton

1 Epic + 1 Feature + 5 User Stories (top-priority subset of PRD-light Section 6).

3. Tracking plan (compressed)

3 leading indicators. 1 monthly review cadence.

4. Value stream (compressed)

Top 3 queues identified.

5. 1 Bottleneck removal experiment

Hypothesis / test / success criterion for one queue.

Triad protocol

1. **SEP-light** (20 min):

- 5 min: 3 stakeholders + RACI for the most consequential decision
- 10 min: 1 trade-off brief (pull from TCD-light Section 5)
- 5 min: 1 simulated negotiation outcome

2. **DP-light** (20 min):

- 5 min: outcome map (primary + 2 supporting + counter)
- 5 min: backlog skeleton
- 5 min: 3 leading indicators
- 5 min: 1 bottleneck experiment

What "good" looks like

- SEP-light's 1 trade-off brief is in the **stakeholder's currency** (not technical)
- DP-light's primary outcome is **user-visible**
- The leading indicators are **measurable within 7 days**
- The bottleneck experiment has a **measurable success criterion**

Activity 3 — Cross-Artifact Integration Pass

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 3

Purpose

Read all 6 documents top-to-bottom. Catch any remaining contradictions. Add forward / backward references between artifacts.

The 6 documents

1. PRD-light
2. TCD-light
3. TMD-light
4. SEP-light
5. DP-light
6. AI Spec v1

Integration check

For every cross-artifact reference, confirm:

- The reference is **specific** (cite Section, not "see the TCD")
- The referenced section **exists** and **says what's claimed**
- The reference **adds value** (linking provides context the reader needs)

Triad protocol

1. **Solo read-through** (15 min). Each member reads all 6 documents.
2. **Pool issues** (10 min).
3. **Fix in priority order** (15 min): coherence first, prose second.

What "good" looks like

- Every cross-reference is verified
- The 6 documents read as a coherent set, not 6 standalone pieces
- The AI Spec correctly synthesizes the others (the synthesis test)

Activity 4 — Presentation Rehearsal

Format: Triad • 45 min + Wrap • Block 4

Purpose

Rehearse the 15-minute Friday presentation. Time it. Get feedback. Fix what doesn't land.

The presentation structure (15 min)

Time	Section	What's covered
1 min	Customer + problem	Real customer; specific friction
2 min	Outcome	Primary outcome; tied to user/business value
3 min	Architecture stance + top trade-off	Defended in business terms
3 min	Data + API + sequence highlights	Engineering-ready summary
2 min	SLO + key constraint	Latency / availability / one compliance item
2 min	Stakeholder + delivery readiness	SEP-light + DP-light highlights
2 min	What you'd do differently with more time	Honesty + reflection

Plus 5 min Q&A.

Triad protocol

1. **Decide who speaks** (5 min). All 3 triad members on stage; assign sections.
2. **Run-through #1 with timer** (15 min). One pass; nobody interrupts.
3. **Capture what didn't work** (10 min). Where did the timer break? Where did a section drag?
4. **Run-through #2** (15 min). Apply fixes. Time again.

What "good" looks like

- The 15-min limit is held (within 30 sec)
- All three triad voices speak
- The customer + problem section grounds the rest
- The trade-off section is **defended in business terms**, not technical jargon
- The "what we'd do differently" section is **honest**, not performative

Wrap (last 15 min)

Each triad shares:

- Their **opening sentence**
- The **section they're least sure of**

- One **anticipated Q&A question**
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End-of-day checkpoint

Each triad ends Day 4 with:

- ✓ **Validation log** — all 7 checks marked
- ✓ **SEP-light** (1 page)
- ✓ **DP-light** (1 page)
- ✓ **AI Spec v2** (after integration pass)
- ✓ **Final 6-document set**, integrated
- ✓ **Presentation rehearsed** at least twice with timer
- ✓ Final provenance log entry